knowledge," the term *valid* applying to the *means* and not to the *knowledge*. The *pramāṇas* are not the means of *valid knowledge*, but only *valid means* of knowledge, the validity of which is always to be determined by other means. Thus, when the orthodox Indian systems believe in authority as a valid means of knowledge, they do not imply that all testimony is valid, but only that authority is one of the valid means of knowing. When a Westerner opposes authority, he imposes upon authority a validity which is not intended in the Indian recognition of authority as a *pramāṇa*, or he is imposing extra conditions upon authority's being accepted as valid from which he frees perception and inference. Not to include testimony in the sense of the word of a reliable person in one's list of valid sources of knowledge is to reject *prima facie* a vast body of knowledge from the field of philosophical inquiry, and that is hardly justifiable. For such facts as are necessarily revealed by authority alone cannot openly and without prejudice be investigated unless we accept them as the valid data of our knowledge. To refuse to admit testimony as a means of knowledge because not all testimony is true is to throw away the baby with the bath. It is the sheer prejudice of centuries that has unreasonably made Western philosophy blindly ignore the value of knowledge by testimony in philosophy, while retaining it in all other fields. To end with another quotation from the *Bhāṣya:* "In ordinary worldly matters also, a large amount of business is carried on on the basis of the assertions of veracious persons; and here also the trustworthiness of the ordinary veracious expositor is based upon the same three conditions—he has full knowledge of what he is saying, he has sympathy for others (who listen to him), and he has the desire to expound things as they really exist;—and on the basis of these the assertion of the veracious expositor is regarded as trustworthy."[10]

NOTES

1. *Yoga Vasiṣṭha,* II. 18. 2,3. Quoted by B.L. Atreya, *The Philosophy of the Yoga-Vasiṣṭha* (Adyar, Madras: The Theosophical Publishing House, 1936), p. 581.
2. Ganganatha Jha, *Gautama's Nyāyasūtras* (Poona: Oriental Book Agency, 1939), p. 29; I. i. 7.
3. *Ibid.,* p. 30; *Nyāya-bhāṣya,* I. i. 7.
4. F. Max Müller, trans., *Vedānta-sūtras with Śaṅkara's Commentary,* Sacred Books of the East, Vol. XXXIV Part I (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1890), p. 318; II. i. 13. Or, "Śruti, if in conflict with other means of right knowledge, has to be bent so as to accord with the latter"